should be supplied by the county or town: otherwise gaols will never be kept clean and wholesome.[1]

No stable, hogcote or dunghill should be suffered in the court;[2] nor any fowls kept there, which I have often seen not only in the courts, but also in the rooms of many prisons. No gaoler should keep more than one dog, and none should be kept by any prisoner whatever. Sweepings, ashes, etc., should be taken away twice a week. If the bedding is straw, it should be put in coarse canvass; if it is not so enclosed, it ought to be changed every week. Each bed should have a blanket and coarse coverlet, and not be laid on the floor, but on a crib-bedstead, which should be movable for washing the room. This would prevent infection by cutaneous disorders, which are common in prisons. Sir John Pringle observes, p. 51, "There being no straw at Fort Augustus, the men were ordered to cut the heath for bedding; and it was observable, that such as were most careful in providing themselves with a due quantity, and renewing it often, were least sickly." May not one great cause of the unhealthiness of our prisoners be, the want of proper bedding, which obliges them to lie in their clothes? How different did the prisoners appear at Trieste from many that I have seen in Prussia and at Vienna! I was struck with the same good appearance of the women prisoners at several of the spin-houses in Holland. This reminds me of what I heard an old general say, "That he always found his men subject to illness and diseases when they lay in camps, not from dampness, but from lying in their clothes and the want of proper bedding; for at the same time all his officers had been quite healthy and well." Whatever be the cause of this difference, whether a more free perspiration in bed, taking off bandages, or ventilation of the clothes, I am fully convinced of the fact.

Prisoners should not remain in the daytime in the rooms in which they sleep; they should have a common ward, day-room or kitchen, and an allowance of firing. They should also be made to get up early, and be called over—to their bread—and

[1] I have observed in prisons abroad a very cheap and pleasant fumigation, which surprisingly corrects the offensiveness of the bad air. I suppose it is the same as is used in Roman Catholic churches, viz. juniper berries thrown upon burning coals in a chafing-dish.

[2] The Act of Parliament in Ireland, which I mentioned in a former note, orders that "No gaoler or any person employed by him, shall presume on any account to keep in the said gaols, or the yard, or the houses adjoining thereto, and provided for the use of such prisoners, any hogs, cows, or other cattle, under the penalty of forty shillings for such hog, cow, or other beast kept in the said gaol or prison."

prayers. This would divert them, prevent them from sleeping immoderately, and be conducive to health. The doors of all the wards should be open at six in summer, and seven in winter. Debtors should be locked up in their rooms at ten at night as in France and other foreign countries.

Those who drink only water, and have no nutritious liquor, ought to have at least a pound and half of good household bread every day. The bread should be one day old, and then honestly weighed to them. If once a week (suppose on Sunday) some of the coarser pieces of beef were boiled in the copper, and half a pound of the meat without bone given to each prisoner, with a quart of the broth, this Sunday dinner might be made an encouragement to peaceable and orderly behaviour: the turbulent and refractory should not have it. Such an allowance might help to remove a bad custom that obtains too generally, the pretence of refreshing prisoners with better food and drink on Sunday; upon which many are admitted into the gaols, and keep the prisoners from chapel.

I state the allowance in weight, not money, because of the variable price. Besides that quantity of bread, each prisoner should have a penny a day in money for cheese, butter, potatoes, peas, turnips: or he should have an honest pennyworth of one of those articles.

Here, as in the tap, I must insist upon it as highly necessary, that every gaoler, bridewell-keeper, turnkey, etc., be excluded from all concern in the prisoners' allowance; from all profit arising directly or indirectly from the sale of their bread, or other food. Whoever distributes it, should be free from all temptation to fraud: and be subject to a strong check. Scales and weights should be in all prisons, that the prisoners may see that they have their allowance. The whole allowance of prisoners should never be given them in money. In Ireland, the minister of the parish where the gaol is, orders the felons' bread; and keeps (should keep) the account of it: for he is allowed by Act of Parliament the third of George III, chap. xxviii, a sum not exceeding ten pounds a year for the trouble.

The reader will plainly see, that I am not an advocate for an extravagant and profuse allowance to prisoners. I plead only for necessaries, in such a moderate quantity, as may support health and strength for labour. The law allows the poor debtor who is detained in prison, two shillings and four pence a week[1] (I wish it were more easily obtained); and the government

[1] Thirty-second George II.